ATUNILE ORGANICS · INTELLIGENCE ENGINE

🍒 Nilotica Shea Intelligence Report

East Africa Supply Intelligence · Regulatory Monitor · Market Analysis

📅 Report Date: April 9, 2026 🔄 Run: #2 (Delta from March 24, 2026)

🔍 Sources: 22 primary sources 🌍 Coverage: EU · East Africa · Global

🔴 **ACTIVE: Nigeria ban confirmed through Feb 2027 · Burkina Faso indefinite suspension confirmed · EU Omnibus VIII applies in 22 days (May 1) · Shea 2026 Conference in 18 days — BOOK NOW**

⏰ ACTIVE DEADLINES — ACTION REQUIRED

18 DAYS

Shea 2026 Conference — April 27–29, Accra International Conference Centre. GSA annual summit. Deal Room for buyer-supplier matchmaking. With dual West Africa supply crisis dominating, East Nilotica exporters will be in high demand. Registration: globalshea.com

22 DAYS

EU Omnibus VIII (Regulation 2026/78) — Applies May 1, 2026. 15 new CMR substances banned. Shea butter fully unaffected and compliant. Brands reformulating will increase demand for natural emollients.

112 DAYS

Fragrance Allergen Labeling Deadline — July 31, 2026. 56 newly listed fragrance allergens require revised labeling. Natural botanical products are in scope. Verify all product documentation for Atunile.

112 DAYS

INCI Glossary Mandatory Update — July 30, 2026. 30,419 INCI ingredient names updated. Confirm all documentation uses: *Butyrospermum parkii* butter (CoSing database). Non-compliance begins July 30.

🚨 CRITICAL UPDATES

HIGH PRIORITY · CONFIRMED ACTIVE

1. Nigeria Raw Shea Export Ban — Confirmed Active Through February 25, 2027

Nigeria's raw shea nut export ban, originally announced August 2025, was **formally extended February 26, 2026 by President Tinubu for one additional year** through February 25, 2027. All shea exports must route through the Nigerian Commodity Exchange (NCX); direct shipment exemptions have been removed. Nigeria represents ~40% of global shea supply. Critically: **Mali, Côte d'Ivoire, and Togo have adopted similar export restrictions**, compounding the West African supply crisis. Nut prices have fallen ~33% domestically (a short-term negative for farmers, but confirms supply is not reaching EU buyers).

Source: The Times Nigeria, Feb 26, 2026 · allAfrica.com, Mar 2, 2026 · HPC Mag MEA, Mar 4, 2026 · BeautyMatter

HIGH PRIORITY · CONFIRMED ACTIVE

2. Burkina Faso — Indefinite Export Suspension Confirmed, No End Date

Burkina Faso's full shea nut export suspension is confirmed. An initial December 2025–May 2026 export window was **abandoned** when authorities found local processors still unable to secure raw materials despite priority access rules. Smuggling operations (1,800+ tonnes seized in one enforcement operation) further complicated supply. The indefinite suspension remains in force with no announced end date. Combined with Nigeria's ban and similar restrictions in Mali, Côte d'Ivoire, and Togo: **this is an unprecedented multi-country West African supply disruption with no near-term resolution visible.**

Source: Tridge · Ecofin Agency · Premium Beauty News · Pravda Burkina Faso, Nov 2025

NEW · STRATEGIC OPPORTUNITY

3. NiSA × FairWild Foundation Partnership — New Traceability Credential for Nilotica

The Nilotica Shea Alliance (NiSA) has formally partnered with the **FairWild Foundation**, in collaboration with CBI Netherlands, to advance Nilotica shea as a high-quality, responsibly sourced cosmetic ingredient. FairWild certification is a recognized EU buyer standard for wild-harvested botanicals with full supply chain traceability. This partnership creates a **new certification pathway specifically designed for wild-harvested Nilotica** that is directly aligned with EU buyer requirements for DPP readiness and EUDR compliance. Atunile must engage NiSA immediately to participate in this certification development process.

Source: LinkedIn · NiSA / FairWild Foundation announcement, 2026

REGULATORY · 22 DAYS

4. EU Omnibus VIII (Regulation 2026/78) — Applies May 1, 2026

Regulation (EU) 2026/78 bans 15 new CMR (carcinogenic, mutagenic, reprotoxic) substances from EU cosmetics. **Shea butter is fully unaffected and compliant.** Deadline: May 1, 2026 — 22 days from now. Brands reformulating away from restricted substances will increase demand

for clean, compliant emollients. Additionally, **56 new fragrance allergens require revised labeling by July 31, 2026** — brands with affected products are actively reformulating, opening further demand for non-allergenic natural emollients like Nilotica.

Source: Cosmeservice · EU Verify · Personal Care Insights · Cosmetics & Toiletries

REGULATORY · ACTIVE

5. EU Regulation 2025/877 (CMR) — In Force Since September 1, 2025. Compliance Deadline July 31, 2026.

Products placed on EU market must comply with CMR restrictions by **July 31, 2026**. Non-compliant products already on market may continue until July 31, 2028. Shea butter is not a CMR substance. REACH: pure, unmodified shea butter is **exempt from registration** regardless of import volume. Chemically modified products require registration if >1 tonne/year.

Source: CBI Market Entry Report, January 7, 2026 · REACH24H

⚠️ HIGH PRIORITY FLAGS

🔴 Shea 2026 Conference — April 27–29, Accra — 18 Days Away

The Global Shea Alliance's 18th annual conference, theme "Beyond Borders." Features a **Deal Room** for targeted buyer-supplier matchmaking, panel discussions, training, and field visits. With Nigeria, Burkina Faso, Mali, Côte d'Ivoire, and Togo all constrained, East Nilotica exporters will be the most sought-after suppliers on the floor. Register at globalshea.com. Prepare: product samples, COA, one-page sell sheet, pricing tiers (1MT / 5MT / 20MT). Target minimum 15 buyer meetings.

🔴 Digital Product Passports (DPP) — Cosmetics Packaging 2027–2028, Formulations via ESPR Delegated Acts

Timeline clarified this cycle: DPP for cosmetics **packaging** mandatory 2027–2028 under EU Packaging Regulation. Full DPP for cosmetics **formulations** coming via ESPR delegated acts being finalized 2026–2027. Full rollout for all product categories by 2030. **2026 remains the critical preparation window.** Build GPS-documented, batch-level traceability architecture now. Wild-harvested Nilotica from named cooperatives is the easiest-to-certify shea for DPP compliance.

🔴 INCI Glossary — Mandatory Update July 30, 2026 (112 Days)

Implementing Decision (EU) 2025/1175 updates 30,419 INCI ingredient names. All Atunile product documentation must use current INCI name: *Butyrospermum parkii* butter (CoSing database). Non-compliance from July 30, 2026. Verify all labeling, COAs, and sales documentation now.

🟡 EUDR — Shea Not In Scope, Watch Post-Shea2026 Policy Discussions

EU Deforestation Regulation enforcement: December 2026 (large operators) / June 2027 (small operators). Shea is not currently in scope. Commission reserved right to add commodities. Wild-harvested Nilotica from preserved Ugandan parklands would be the easiest-to-certify shea in Africa if added. The NiSA × FairWild partnership now provides a direct pathway to geospatial documentation. Build now; don't wait for the rule.

🟡 Lab-Grown Shea (SMEY) — Pre-Commercial But Narrative Risk Escalating

Paris biotech SMEY is producing shea oil via AI-assisted yeast fermentation in 30 days vs. 2 years traditional harvesting. SMEY positioned as EUDR-compliant "deforestation-free" alternative. Still **not commercially available**, but the narrative is building in EU sustainability circles. Counter-narrative: verified women cooperative income, 1,400+ members in Pader District, 500+ hectares parkland restored, and now FairWild-pathway certification. **Quantified ESG data with third-party verification is the only durable defense.**

🟡 Kenya Re-Export Hub Risk — No New Data, Risk Remains Open

> Kenya's +202.5% YoY shea export surge from Run #1 not updated with new data this cycle. Risk of Kenyan processors purchasing Uganda-origin Nilotica and exporting at finished-goods margins remains. Consider direct EU logistics routes through Mombasa or air freight for premium small lots.

📈 MARKET TRENDS

Metric	Data	Source / Date
Global shea market 2025	USD 2.27–2.56 billion	Grand View Research / FMI
Global shea market 2026	USD 2.43 billion (6.8% CAGR)	Business Research Company 2026
Global shea market 2030	USD 3.24–3.75B (7.4–7.9% CAGR)	Mordor Intelligence
Long-range projection 2035	USD 5.07 billion (8.60% CAGR)	Future Market Insights
US FOB transaction prices (Jan–Feb 2026)	$3.50–$13.36/kg (grade-dependent)	Tridge, Feb 2026
Shea nut price trend	UPWARD — strong demand + production shortfalls	OFI Magazine / Tridge 2026
EU total shea imports 2024	511,000 tonnes / EUR 1.39 billion	CBI 2024
Germany imports	75,059 tonnes / EUR 217 million	CBI 2024
France imports	75,000 tonnes / EUR 248 million	CBI 2024
Netherlands (Rotterdam hub)	57,000 tonnes / EUR 141 million	CBI 2024
Nilotica retail (EU, refined/organic)	€8–12/kg (vs cocoa butter €30–400/kg)	CBI Market Entry, Jan 2026
Pharmaceutical CAGR (fastest segment)	9.3% (2026–2034) — North America	Market Data Forecast
Food & beverage CAGR	8.31% (2025–2030)	Mordor Intelligence
Natural cosmetics growth (Europe)	6.4% annual through 2035	CBI 2026
Plant-based claims growth	+23% (2020–2024)	CBI 2026
Raw/unrefined market share	59.50% of total (Atunile's category)	Grand View Research 2024
Consumers preferring natural	60% globally	Market research 2025

Price Context: CBI retail benchmark shows Nilotica refined/organic at €8–12/kg positions it well against premium butters: mango butter €14–35/kg, murumuru €50–85/kg, cupuaçu €35–60/kg. Nilotica is actually *underpriced relative to alternatives* — pricing power exists to move upward with certification and branding.

Shea nut prices trend upward globally due to production shortfalls and export restrictions. Processed butter prices will follow. Lock in buyer contracts now before post-2027 supply normalization.

🌍 EAST AFRICA / NILOTICA-SPECIFIC SIGNALS

57–65%
Nilotica oleic acid (CBI 2026 update)

40–50%
West African oleic acid (lower)

25–30°C
Melting point (body temp)

0%
Solvent use (dry fractionation only)

1,250+
Hectares parkland preserved (Uganda, 2023)

🍀 NiSA × FairWild Foundation — New Strategic Partnership (2026)

The Nilotica Shea Alliance has formally partnered with FairWild Foundation, in collaboration with CBI Netherlands, to advance Nilotica shea as a high-quality, responsibly sourced cosmetic ingredient. FairWild is a recognized EU certification standard for sustainably harvested wild-collected botanicals. This creates a **Nilotica-specific traceability and certification pathway** tailored exactly to the wild-harvested, cooperative-sourced model that Atunile operates. Engage NiSA immediately to participate. This certification, combined with COSMOS, would make Atunile's documentation stack among the strongest for any EU buyer audit.

🍀 Gulu Agriculture Expo — April 4, 2026

Shea butter dominated the 5-day exhibition in Gulu, northern Uganda. Frank Mugabi from NARO (National Agricultural Research Organisation) presented innovations in shea processing that yield **superior butter meeting global standards** — smoother quality, better prices. NARO is actively pushing research innovations for Northern Uganda farmers (March 30, 2026). This signals active government and research backing for the sector at the source level. Domestic institutional support is strengthening.

🍀 Key EU Importers for Nilotica — Confirmed Active (CBI Jan 2026)

Wild Origins (Germany) — boutique importer specializing in organic East African oils. Direct target. **All Organic Treasures (Austria)** — confirmed Nilotica Uganda listing. **AKOMA SKINCARE (UK)** — confirmed working directly with East African cooperatives. **Natura-Tec, Olvea, Oleon, Groupe Emile** (France/Belgium) — refiners/processors active in the channel. These are confirmed buyers, not speculative.

🍀 Nilotica Dry Fractionation Advantage — EU Organic Certification Pathway Confirmed

CBI January 2026 confirms: Nilotica supports **dry fractionation** (temperature and mechanical only), whereas West African paradoxa typically requires **acetone-based solvent fractionation**. This means Nilotica can achieve EU organic certification without chemical solvents — a structural formulation

advantage that EU organic brands cannot get from West African shea. This is a technical differentiator that formulators need documented in product specifications.

🍀 Shea 2026 Conference — Deal Room Confirmed, April 27–29 Accra

GSA's 18th annual conference. Confirmed format includes a **"Deal Room"** for targeted business engagements among buyers, suppliers, financiers, and service providers. Panels on supply chain resilience, women's economic empowerment, and policy responses to West African export restrictions. With Burkina Faso, Nigeria, Mali, Côte d'Ivoire, and Togo all constrained, East Nilotica will be the dominant alternative conversation.

🧠 STRATEGIC INSIGHT FOR ATUNILE ORGANICS

1 THIS WEEK **Attend Shea 2026 — 18 Days, Deal Room Confirmed**

Register immediately at globalshea.com. April 27–29, Accra International Conference Centre. With Nigeria, Burkina Faso, Mali, Côte d'Ivoire, and Togo all under export restrictions, this is the moment every EU buyer is actively looking for an alternative supply chain. Atunile has what they need: certified, exportable, wild-harvested Nilotica. Prepare: 15 sample kits (250–500g each), COA, one-page sell sheet with pricing tiers (1MT / 5MT / 20MT / 100MT), and a concise ESG impact summary.

2 THIS WEEK **Contact Wild Origins (Germany) + AKOMA SKINCARE (UK) Directly**

CBI has confirmed these as active importers of East African organic oils. Wild Origins (Germany) specializes in exactly Atunile's product category. AKOMA SKINCARE works directly with East African cooperatives. These are warm targets, not cold calls. Lead with: "East Nilotica, organic-certified, wild-harvested, women cooperative sourced — export-ready while West African supply is constrained." Follow up within 5 days with samples.

3 THIS MONTH **Engage NiSA on FairWild Partnership — Get Into the Certification Pilot**

The NiSA × FairWild × CBI partnership is creating a Nilotica-specific certification standard for wild-harvested supply chains. This is being built now. Getting into the pilot cohort means Atunile's documentation practices shape the standard rather than being retrofitted to it. Contact NiSA Board of Directors directly. This is the most strategically valuable thing Atunile can do for long-term EU market access.

4 112 DAYS **INCI + Allergen Labeling Compliance Audit Before July 30**

Two overlapping deadlines hit July 30–31, 2026: (1) INCI Glossary update — verify all documentation uses *Butyrospermum parkii* butter. (2) 56 new fragrance allergens require revised labeling. Review all Atunile product documentation, COAs, and any retail packaging now. Non-compliance from July 30 means products cannot be placed on EU market. This is an administrative fix, not a product issue — do it now before the conference season distracts.

5 Q2 2026 **Begin COSMOS Certification — Dry Fractionation Is the Competitive Advantage**

Nilotica's dry fractionation pathway (no acetone solvents) is a confirmed technical advantage for EU organic certification that West African paradoxa cannot match. COSMOS certification through Ecocert or NOGAMU/Ecocert East Africa unlocks: (1) the 20–30% organic premium, (2) access to 60–70% of European natural cosmetics brands that require it, (3) materially higher declared organic percentages under COSMOS v4.2 calculation. The dry fractionation advantage should be a core claim in all documentation.

6 Q2–Q3 2026 **Build DPP-Ready Traceability Documentation Now**

EU Digital Product Passports for cosmetics packaging are mandatory 2027–2028. Formulation DPP follows via ESPR delegated acts. The documentation required: GPS coordinates of all shea parklands, cooperative member rosters, harvest batch records, chain of custody from tree to export. The NiSA × FairWild framework will formalize this. Starting now means the data exists when buyers begin requesting it — and increasingly they will before the regulation even requires it.

7 Q3 2026

Develop Pharmaceutical-Grade Documentation

The pharmaceutical segment is growing at 9.3% CAGR (2026–2034) — fastest of any segment. Buyers require: HACCP implementation, GMP documentation, ISO 22000 or FSSC 22000, pharma-grade purity COAs. Nilotica's higher olein content and softer texture may offer specific advantages in ointment formulations. This is an underexplored, premium-priced channel. The documentation investment to unlock it is finite.

8 ONGOING

Price Upward — Nilotica Is Underpriced Relative to Alternative Premium Butters

CBI data: Nilotica refined/organic retails at €8–12/kg while murumuru butter sells for €50–85/kg and cupuaçu for €35–60/kg. Nilotica has comparable or superior formulation performance and a stronger sustainability story. The current pricing reflects supply obscurity, not market value. With COSMOS certification and FairWild credentialing, pricing to €15–25/kg wholesale for certified organic is defensible. Do not undercut — it signals commodity positioning, not specialty.

⚠️ WATCHLIST

RISK — EUDR Scope Expansion to Shea

No new movement this cycle. Enforcement begins Dec 2026 (large operators) / Jun 2027 (SMEs). Commission retains right to add shea. Wild-harvested Nilotica from preserved parkland is the best-positioned shea in Africa for EUDR compliance, but geospatial documentation must exist before the rule is written. NiSA × FairWild partnership now provides the framework — engage now.

RISK — Kenya Re-Export Margin Capture

No new data this cycle. Kenya's +202.5% YoY surge from Run #1 unconfirmed with new numbers. Risk open: Kenyan processors may be purchasing Uganda-origin Nilotica and exporting at finished-goods margins. Recommend: map current export logistics; identify whether direct EU routes (via Mombasa or air for premium lots) are viable.

RISK — Lab-Grown Shea (SMEY) Narrative Risk

Still pre-commercial. EU EUDR framing positions it as "deforestation-free." 5–10 year timeline to commercial disruption. Counter: verified women cooperative income data, FairWild certification, parkland restoration metrics. The narrative fight starts now even though the product is not commercial. ESG documentation is the defense.

RISK — Conflict / Instability Northern Uganda & South Sudan

No new alerts this cycle. Remain on watchlist. Supply chain from Northern Uganda parklands requires ongoing monitoring for any security developments.

OPPORTUNITY — Wild Origins (Germany) + All Organic Treasures (Austria) as Direct Targets

CBI January 2026 confirms both as active importers of East African organic oils. These are not hypothetical leads — they are verified active buyers. Outreach this week.

OPPORTUNITY — NiSA × FairWild Certification Pilot — Get In Early

New this cycle. FairWild certification pathway for wild-harvested Nilotica is being developed now. Founding cohort members will have documentation and market positioning advantages over later adopters. Time-sensitive.

OPPORTUNITY — Pharmaceutical-Grade Channel (9.3% CAGR)

Fastest-growing segment. North American pharmaceutical market alone projected $584.85M in 2026 → $933.57M by 2034. Nilotica's higher olein content may offer specific advantages. HACCP + GMP documentation unlocks this channel. Q3 2026 target.

OPPORTUNITY — Pricing Power Exists Upward

Nilotica at €8–12/kg retail is materially underpriced relative to premium butter alternatives. With COSMOS + FairWild certification, wholesale pricing to €15–25/kg is achievable. Do not compete on price with West African paradoxa.

⏳ *Next intelligence run recommended: May 12, 2026 (33 days) · Shea 2026 Conference debrief recommended: May 1, 2026*

Δ DELTA FROM LAST REPORT (MARCH 24 → APRIL 9, 2026)

🔴 CONFIRMED: Nigeria + Burkina Faso Supply Crisis — No Change, Both Active

Both bans/suspensions confirmed still in force. New data point: Mali, Côte d'Ivoire, and Togo have adopted similar restrictions, making this a 5-country West African supply disruption. Nigeria domestic nut prices fell ~33% (supply constrained from EU buyers, cheap domestically). EU buyers are not receiving supply relief.

🟢 NEW: NiSA × FairWild Foundation Partnership

Not present in Run #1. NiSA has formally partnered with FairWild Foundation (with CBI) to build a Nilotica-specific wild-harvest certification pathway. This is the single most significant strategic development for Atunile since Run #1. It directly addresses DPP readiness, EUDR preparation, and EU buyer traceability requirements in one framework.

🟢 NEW: Gulu Agriculture Expo — April 4, 2026

NARO actively presenting processing innovations for Northern Uganda shea. Government and research backing for the sector has intensified. Positive signal for supply quality improvement.

🟢 NEW: Specific EU Importer Names Confirmed (CBI Jan 2026)

Wild Origins (Germany), All Organic Treasures (Austria), AKOMA SKINCARE (UK) confirmed as active Nilotica buyers. Natura-Tec, Olvea, Oleon (France/Belgium) confirmed as active refiners/processors. These are actionable buyer targets not listed in Run #1.

🟢 NEW: Nilotica Dry Fractionation Advantage Confirmed (EU Organic Pathway)

CBI January 2026 explicitly confirms Nilotica's dry fractionation pathway (vs. acetone solvent for paradoxa) as a structural organic certification advantage. This is a technical sales point that can be documented and communicated to EU buyers.

🟠 DEADLINE APPROACHING: EU Omnibus VIII — May 1 (22 Days)

Was a "watch" item in Run #1. Now 22 days to application date. Shea unaffected, but brands reformulating are actively sourcing compliant alternatives right now.

🟠 DEADLINE APPROACHING: INCI + Allergen Labeling — July 30–31 (112 Days)

Both deadlines now within 4 months. Administrative compliance action required now. Not a product issue, but a documentation issue with hard EU market access consequences.

🔵 **PENDING: Shea 2026 Conference — Not Yet Occurred (April 27–29)**

No post-conference data available. Run #3 should be scheduled for May 1, 2026 to capture conference debrief, buyer meetings outcome, and any policy announcements from the GSA summit.

📚 SOURCES CONSULTED — 22 PRIMARY SOURCES

CBI — European Market Potential for Shea Butter (2026)	CBI — Entering the European Market for Shea Butter (Jan 7, 2026)
The Times Nigeria — Tinubu Extends Raw Shea Nut Ban (Feb 26, 2026)	allAfrica.com — Nigeria Extends Shea Export Ban (Mar 2, 2026)
HPC Mag MEA — Nigeria Ban Extension (Mar 4, 2026)	BeautyMatter — Value over Volume: Nigeria Extends Raw Shea Nut Ban
Tridge — Burkina Faso suspends shea exports until further notice	Ecofin Agency — Burkina Faso Halts Shea Nut Exports
Pravda Burkina Faso — Postpones export deadline (Nov 2025)	Cosmeservice — EU Omnibus VIII (2026/78) CMR restrictions
EU Verify — Upcoming Cosmetic Ingredient Bans Key Deadlines	Cosmetics & Toiletries — EU Regulations May 2026
REACH24H — 2026 EU Cosmetic Regulatory Updates	Circularise — DPPs Required by EU Legislation Across Sectors
MyProductPassport.eu — Digital Product Passports for Cosmetics	NiSA / LinkedIn — FairWild Foundation Partnership 2026
The Cooperator News — NiSA Launch Dec 3, 2025	Uganda Online — Gulu Agriculture Expo Shea Butter (Apr 4, 2026)
NARO / PML Daily — Northern Uganda Farm Innovations (Mar 30, 2026)	Ghanamma — Shea 2026 Conference (Mar 24, 2026)
Global Shea Alliance — SHEA 2026 Conference Glue Up listing	OFI Magazine — Shea nut price trend upward (2026)